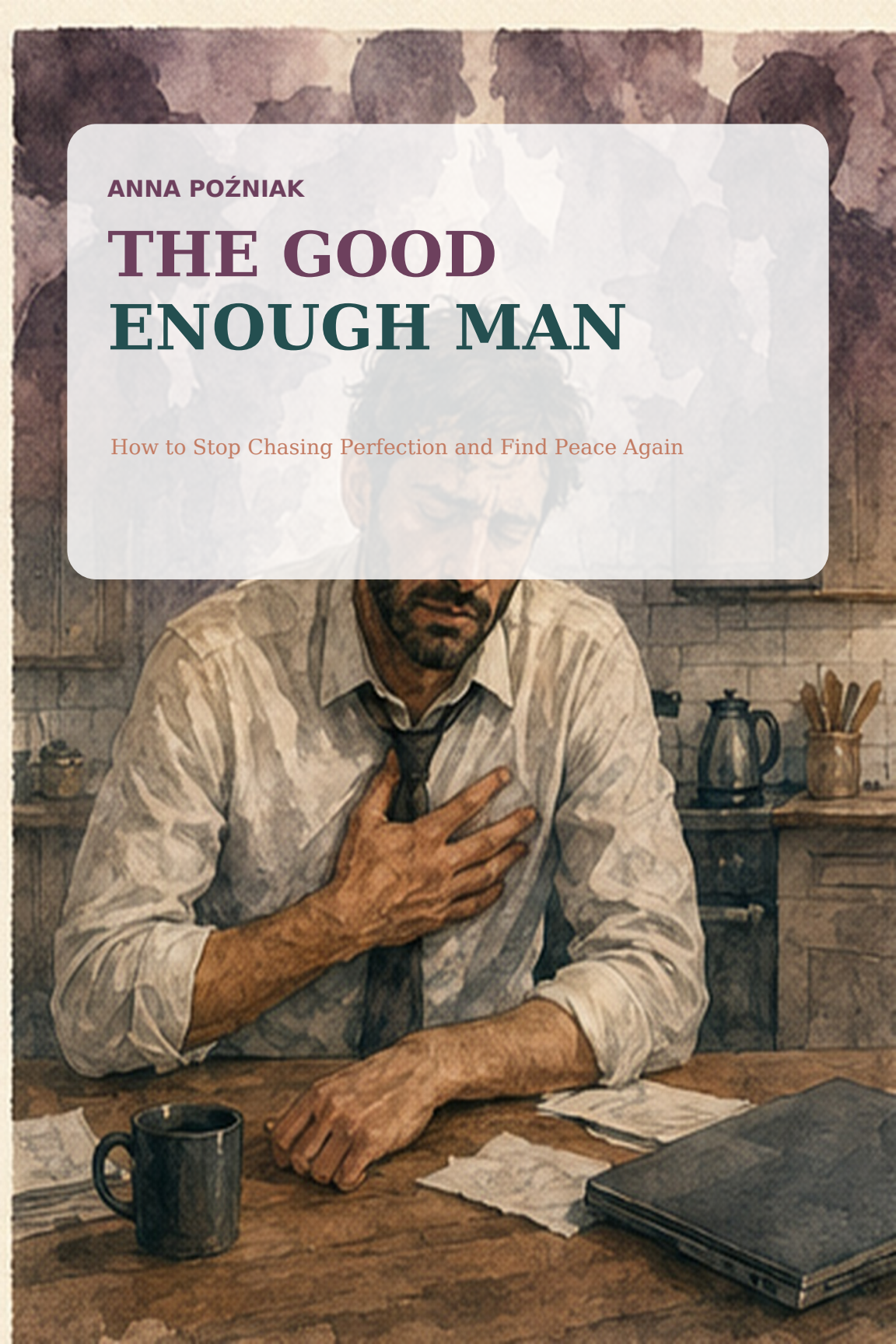


The background of the entire image is a painting of a man with a beard, wearing a white button-down shirt and a dark tie. He is sitting at a wooden desk, looking down with a somber expression, his right hand resting on his chest. On the desk in front of him are a dark mug, some crumpled papers, and a closed laptop. The background of the painting shows a rustic kitchen setting with a stone wall, a wooden counter, a kettle, and a jar of utensils.

ANNA POŻNIAK

THE GOOD ENOUGH MAN

How to Stop Chasing Perfection and Find Peace Again

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About This Book

"The Good Enough Man" is a book for men who feel the burden of responsibilities, pressure and expectations every day. For those who try to be strong, responsible, composed... even when everything is screaming inside. It's a story about a man who gives more than he should, and who slowly loses himself in it.

This book doesn't tell you how to live. It makes no promises. It reminds you: you don't have to be perfect, you don't have to prove anything, you don't have to carry the whole world on your shoulders.

Inside you will find true stories, quiet reflections and moments of silence that will help you feel like yourself again.

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CHAPTER 01

The Pressure That Takes Your Breath Away



The Pressure That Takes Your Breath Away

You know this feeling all too well. As if someone was pressing their hand on your chest. As if you were ready to run even though no one gave you the starting shot.

You don't know what you're running from. Maybe from responsibility. Maybe before failure. Maybe before the silence that reminds you how tired you are.

The word "I have to" has become part of your breath. I have to earn money. I have to be strong. I have to manage everything.

And when you succeed, no one notices. But all it takes is one time when you can't cope - and you feel like you've failed the whole world.

You are not a robot. You are not a titan. And you don't have to be.

There is a boy inside you who just wanted someone to appreciate him. Not for results. Not for success. Simply for trying.

Sometimes a man doesn't need advice. I just need someone to ask, "How are you feeling today?" And that the answer could be: "Wrong."

Without analyzing. No judgment. No "you have to be strong".

Stop now. Close your eyes. Breathe.

Not to calm down. But to feel that you really exist.

That your body is not just a tool for work. That your mind is not only about plans and responsibilities. That there is someone inside you who still just wants to be.

A man once told me, "I can't remember the last time I didn't feel pressured."

And maybe that's the point - to start with one day where you don't have to prove anything.

Do it now. Not as an exercise. Not as a task. Sit down. Close your eyes. Breathe slowly. Feel your shoulders drop. Feel like you don't have to be vigilant. Feel like you don't have to fix anything. Feel that today it is enough that you are.

You're not a bad person. You didn't disappoint. You don't have to run away anymore.

CHAPTER 02

The Voice Within



The Voice Within

You know him. It's not loud. He doesn't scream.

It's that whisper that comes when something goes wrong.
"You could have done more." "Others made it." "You are not enough."

Sometimes they're not even words. That feeling in your stomach. That strange burden that says: you failed again.

No, this voice is not yours. It's an echo. A remnant of someone else's words that once absorbed into you.

Father. Teacher. A woman who said something in anger. A world that demanded that you be tougher than you were capable of being.

You see, this voice doesn't want to destroy you. He simply doesn't know anything else. He kept you in check for years to keep you going. To make you better. So that you don't give up.

But today you don't have to fight like that anymore. Today you don't need a soldier inside you.

Today you can simply have a human inside you.

I remember a man who told me, "That voice never lets me rest. When I achieve something, it says: You could have done it faster. When I rest, it says: You're lazy. I don't know how to live with it."

I told him, "Don't try to silence him. Try to hear him. And tell him calmly - you don't have to protect me anymore."

Because that voice doesn't go away when you shout at it. It disappears when it is understood.

You are not what you think of yourself. You are not your mistakes. You are not someone else's disappointment.

You are someone who gets up every day, even when you lack strength. Someone who keeps trying despite the pressure. Someone who learns to speak more gently to herself. And that's enough.

Do it now. Sit down. Close your eyes. Listen. What does your inner voice say? Don't run away from him. Don't drown it out. Just reply, "I hear you. But today I speak for myself."

You are not that voice. You are not to blame for having it in you. But you can choose the silence that comes after it.

CHAPTER 03

Far From Home



Far From Home

There are evenings when the silence has a scent. Old sofa, dust, tea cooling on the table. A radio playing in the background just to keep the emptiness from being too loud.

Some men left - for work, for a better tomorrow. They left children, wives and everyday life that hurt and loved at the same time. Others never had a place to return to. They rent rooms, move from city to city, live between one paycheck and the weekend, and no one asks, "How are you?"

Loneliness has many faces. Some people keep their wedding ring in a drawer. Some people keep an empty dating site account. Some people miss what they once had. Others long for something they have never experienced.

But inside it feels the same. The same silence on the other side of the table. The same sigh when the light goes out.

Sometimes you come home from work, take off your shoes, open a beer, and turn on the TV series. Not because you want to, but because you don't want to hear yourself.

Because when things get really quiet, there's this voice: "Will it always be like this?"

There's nothing wrong with missing someone. There is no shame in wanting closeness. You don't have to be a lone wolf to be a man.

I know men who say they prefer to be alone. But when the light goes out, you can see something else in their eyes - not fear, not regret, but the desire for someone who will understand their silence.

Being far from home isn't always about geography. Sometimes it's the distance between you and the world. Between who you are and who you have to be every day.

But even in this distance there is something real. Because loneliness teaches you to see more clearly. On myself. On others. For life - without frills.

You don't have to pretend it doesn't hurt. You don't have to explain it. Just admit to yourself, "I miss someone." It's not a weakness. It's humanity.

Do it now. Turn off the light. Sit in silence. Think about one person who was once close to you. Not to regret it - but to remind yourself that you can still feel. Then think about someone you haven't met yet. And believe it is possible. That no

you have everything behind you.

You are not alone. Not because someone is waiting for you - but because you still feel. And that means you're alive.

CHAPTER 04

Emotions Have a Right to Exist



Emotions Have a Right to Exist

You were raised to be tough. So as not to whine. To not talk when something hurts.

But you know what's the hardest thing? Not anger. Not sadness. The hardest thing is to feel nothing.

Because when you suppress your emotions long enough, you turn into someone who lives behind the glass. You see the world, but you are not part of it. You exist - but as if you weren't really there.

Sometimes anger is not the enemy. It's just a scream of pain that was never allowed to escape. This is energy that had nowhere to go. And only when you look at it does it stop burning you from the inside.

It's not about shouting. The point is to stop pretending you don't feel anything.

A man once told me: "I am calm at work. I am silent at home. But when something breaks inside me, I don't know what to do with it. Because men don't cry."

And I told him, "You're not crying because no one ever showed you how to do it without shame."

Tears are not weakness. This is the moment when your body stops pretending that you have already fixed everything.

Today, try not to run away from what you feel. Don't analyze it. Don't look for someone to blame. Just allow yourself to be in whatever emotion arises. Anger. Pain. Helplessness. Sadness. They're not enemies. It's news.

Don't silence them. Listen.

Do it now. Sit in silence. Close your eyes. Name the emotion you feel. Don't explain it to her. Don't try to fix it. Just say, "You have a right to be here."

You're not cold. You are not weak. You are a man who begins to feel. And that is courage.

CHAPTER 05

Letting Go



Letting Go

Letting go is one of the hardest things a man can do. Because you've been taught to fight all your life. Hold on. Never loosen your grip.

But sometimes the greatest strength comes from opening your hand.

You don't have to fix everything. You don't have to save everyone. Not every problem is your responsibility.

You are not a bridge that everyone can cross. You are not a battery that can be endlessly discharged by other people's expectations.

You are human.

I once heard a sentence that I have never forgotten: "I don't let go because I don't care. I let go because I finally want to breathe."

And that's exactly the point. Letting go is not giving up. It's choosing yourself.

There is room for peace in your life. You don't have to prove endlessly how much you can carry. Sometimes

just say, "Enough." And let something fall apart on its own.

Not everything has to survive. Not everything makes sense. Not everyone you love will stay.

But you can stay with yourself.

Do it now. Think of one thing you hold onto out of fear. See it clearly. Name her. And ask yourself, "What would happen if I let it go?"

You don't have to do anything. Just thinking about it is the beginning of the breath.

Letting go doesn't take away your strength. It gives it back to you.

CHAPTER 06

People You Do Not Have to Pretend Around



People You Do Not Have to Pretend Around

Everyone has people for whom they play a role. In meetings, at work, in the family. Masks you put on out of habit. A smile that doesn't always mean something.

But there are also those who you can just be there for. No brilliant retorts. No strong poses. No pretending that everything is fine.

Sometimes it's just one person. He doesn't have to say anything smart. She just needs to listen as if she really hears you. With her, even silence stops weighing heavily.

A man once told me, "I'm not afraid of being alone. I'm afraid I'll never be able to be myself around anyone again."

And maybe that's what closeness is all about. Not about sharing a bed, not about plans, not about obligation, but about a space

where you can relax. A place where no one expects you to be better than you are.

Don't look for people to whom you have to prove your worth. Look for those who make you forget about yourself for a moment. The ones who make your laugh sound different. The ones that make your breathing easier.

You're not hard to love. You are not "too little" or "too much." It's just that not everyone had the courage to actually see you.

Do it now. Think of one person with whom you can be yourself. Send her a message. Don't overthink it - just let her know you're thinking about her.

Because maybe today she also needs to hear: "You don't have to pretend."

The most beautiful relationships are those in which you can breathe deeply.

CHAPTER 07

You Are Enough



You Are Enough

Finally that day comes. No fireworks, no breakthroughs, no one to congratulate you.

You just wake up and feel like you don't have to chase anyone anymore. You don't have to compare yourself to anyone anymore. You don't have to prove anything anymore.

You were ambitious, responsible, strong. And it was all good.

But it was never about being "more". It was about being "real."

"Enough" is not a word of resignation. It's a word of relief. Wisdom. A silence that is not emptiness, but peace.

Maybe you have scars. Maybe not everything worked out. Maybe you haven't always been the father, partner, or man you wanted to be.

But you know what? You're still here. You're still trying. And that means more than you think.

I once knew a man who said, "All my life I wanted someone to tell me that was enough."

So I tell you now: You are enough.

You just need to be here. You just need to breathe. It's enough that you don't stop looking for the good in yourself.

Do it now. Look in the mirror. Don't correct yourself. Don't look away. Just say, "I am enough."

Not as an affirmation. As the truth.

You don't need anyone else's approval. You have the right to peace. You have the right to be yourself. You have the right to be happy - exactly as you are.

CHAPTER 08

Peace Instead of the Race



Peace Instead of the Race

There comes a point when you stop wanting to race. With others. With your own past. Even with myself.

Something else awakens in you - a quiet need for peace. Not the kind that lasts five minutes after meditation. The kind that comes when you stop fighting to make everything perfect.

You don't have to understand everything anymore. You don't have to fix what's broken. You don't have to be a role model, a hero, or a rock.

The world doesn't need perfect men. I need real ones.

Those who can stop. Who can say "I don't know". Who can ask for help. Who get up in the morning not because they "have to", but because they "want to".

Being calm doesn't mean nothing hurts. It means that pain no longer rules your life. It means that there is room within you - even for the silence that once terrified you.

A man once told me, "I realized I don't need any more plans. It's enough that I finally have myself."

And maybe that's the point. It's not about finding your big purpose. But it's about feeling like yourself again - without fear, without race, without pressure.

Do it now. Go outside or to the balcony. Take a deep breath. Look at the sky. Don't plan for tomorrow. Don't analyze yesterday. Just be - here, now, in this moment.

You don't have to run away anymore. You don't have to be afraid anymore. You can just live.

CHAPTER 09

You Are Not Alone



You Are Not Alone

I want you to know one thing: pressure, a sense of obligation, exhaustion, and the constant need to "be strong" are experiences that many men share every day. The burden of expectations, loneliness, hiding emotions - these are not signs of weakness. These are signs of humanity.

Loneliness is not only about the physical absence of people around you. It's the lack of a real connection - someone you trust, who you can tell the truth, who can hear the feelings you have inside. Many men go through this in silence, believing that they have to deal with it on their own. This is not weakness - it is a signal that seeking support is natural and necessary.

In this chapter, I want to share with you real stories of men who have faced difficult moments in life. Let their stories be proof that you are not alone in your struggles.

The first story belongs to Tomek - a man surrounded by people every day, who nevertheless returned to an empty apartment, feeling completely alone. His experience shows that true loneliness

has nothing to do with the number of friends you have - everything to do with the depth of your relationships and whether you feel heard. Tomek tried to fill the void with the gym, hobbies and TV series, but nothing could replace a conversation with someone who really understood him. Only when he dared to talk about his feelings did he start building real bonds.

It was similar with Jacob. Although his life looked full and stable from the outside, life abroad made him feel like he didn't belong anywhere. Thousands of conversations and smiles could not replace the closeness and support that every person needs. Jakub learned that loneliness does not depend on the number of people around - but on the quality of relationships and the courage to open up. This taught him the importance of seeking real connection—not just companionship.

Marek was struggling with another difficulty - a disease that seemed impossible to overcome. Despite being diagnosed with a terminal illness, he did not give up. He fought every day and lived his life to the fullest. I witnessed his most difficult moments, when the pain and exhaustion became unbearable. And yet he lived bravely, loved deeply and was present until the very end. His story shows that strength is not the absence of suffering - it is facing it while still choosing life.

Adam experienced loneliness due to unrequited love and lack of trust. Most of my adult life

he loved one woman deeply, but circumstances drove them apart. Since then, he has lived cautiously, afraid to trust again. His story teaches that a broken heart does not make a man weak. It shapes understanding, resilience and maturity.

Paul searched for love for many years, going through disappointments, mistakes and betrayals. Despite everything, he never stopped believing in true love. His story is still being written – but it shows that hope, patience and courage are essential. Those who open their hearts despite past wounds have the greatest chance of finding the love they dream of.

The stories of Tomek, Jakub, Mark, Adam and Paweł show one truth clearly: You are not alone. Loneliness, pressure, pain, unrequited love and difficult choices affect every man. Some battles end in victory, some don't - but all teach courage, resilience and humanity.

I wish you the courage to feel your emotions, seek support and open your heart to real relationships. Let the dreams, goals and desires that you carry within you find their way to fulfillment.

Because in the end, what matters is not the number of days you live - but how you live them and who stands next to you when you face your greatest challenges.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Thank You

Thank you for staying until the end. That you allowed yourself to read something that wasn't always easy.

It means that somewhere inside you still want to feel. Not just function - but feel.

And that's courage.

This book was not written to fix you. It was written so that you could finally see that you were never broken.

You don't have to be stronger. You don't have to be better. You don't have to be someone else.

All you have to do is be real, imperfect, alive.

"There is nothing more beautiful than a man who has stopped being afraid of himself."

Anna Pożniak